

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12402759
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
Inventor(s)	Weber; Cindi et al.

Drying apparatus

Abstract

A drying apparatus of the present disclosure has a drying towel having a first face and a second face. The drying apparatus also has a first handle secured to the first face of the drying towel at or near an end of the drying towel so that a caregiver can grasp the drying towel to dry a disabled person with the second face.

Inventors:	Weber; Cindi (Boaz, AL), Weber; James (Boaz, AL)
Applicant:	Weber; Cindi (Boaz, AL); Weber; James (Boaz, AL)
Family ID:	93927932
Appl. No.:	18/823077
Filed:	September 03, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240423421 A1	Dec. 26, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation-in-part parent-doc US 18208180 20230609 ABANDONED child-doc US 18823077

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.:	A47K10/12 (20060101); A47K10/02 (20060101)
U.S. Cl.:	
CPC	A47K10/02 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: A47K (10/02)

USPC: 34/95

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
2011/0046588	12/2010	Jensen	604/385.01	A61F 13/15

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
3119024	12/1999	JP	N/A
2020062153	12/2019	JP	N/A

Primary Examiner: McCormack; John P

Attorney, Agent or Firm: HULSEY P.C.

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application is a continuation-in-part of and claims priority to Nonprovisional patent application Ser. No. 18/208,180 entitled Drying Apparatus filed on Jun. 9, 2023, which is incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND

(1) Caregivers often have a challenging time giving disabled individuals baths or showers. In this regard, the caregiver must position the person differently to ensure that each part of the disabled person's body is dried. In some instances, the caregiver might find it necessary to hold the disabled person with one hand and towel dry with the other hand. This is difficult to do with a conventional towel.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWING FIGURES

- (1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a drying towel in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a face view of the drying towel as shown in FIG. 1.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a long side view of the drying towel as shown in FIG. 1.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a short side view of the drying towel as shown in FIG. 1.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a face view of a drying towel having handles on a short end of the drying towel in accordance with another embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (6) FIG. 6 is a face view of a drying towel having handles on a long end of the drying towel in accordance with another embodiment of the present disclosure.

DESCRIPTION

- (7) The present disclosure relates to a drying towel in accordance with an embodiment of the

present disclosure. The exemplary drying towel is rectangular. On one face of the towel is a plurality of handles. Note that the rectangular shape of the towel is for exemplary purposes only. A drying towel in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure may be other geometric shapes in other embodiments, e.g., circular, square, triangular, etc. Note that the drying towel can be any size known in the art or future-developed, e.g., 16"×27", 16"×30", 27"×52", 30"×60", or 35"×60".

(8) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of an exemplary drying towel **100** in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. The exemplary towel **100** is rectangular. However, the exemplary towel **100** may be other geometric shapes in other embodiments, e.g., circular, square, triangular, etc. Further, the drying towel may be many sizes, including but not limited to 16"×27", 16"×30", 27"×52", 30"×60", or 35"×60".

(9) The exemplary drying towel **100** has long parallel edges **110** and **111**. Further, the exemplary drying towel **100** has short parallel edges **112** and **113**.

(10) Secured to the drying towel **100** is a plurality of handles **103** and **107**. The handles **103** and **107** are secured to a face **101** of the drying towel **100** at or near the edges **110** and **111** and/or **112** and **113**, respectively. Securing the handles **103** and **107** at or near the edges **110** and **111** and/or **112** and **113** allows the caregiver full use of the opposite face (not shown) of the drying towel **100** for drying a disabled person. In use, a caregiver may slip his/her hand (not shown) through the handles **103** and **107** to maintain a grasp on the drying towel **100** and to have full use of the face (not shown) of the drying towel **100** opposite the face **101** to which the handles **103** and **107** are secured.

(11) The exemplary drying towel **100** comprises a long rectangular swath of fabric **102** along the long edge **110** of the drying towel **100**. The long rectangular swath of fabric **102** is secured to the face **101** of drying towel at regular intervals along the long rectangular swath of fabric **102** via stitches **105**.

(12) The stitches **105** form the handle **103**. The handle **103** forms an opening **104** in which the caregiver can slip his/her hand.

(13) Note that the exemplary drying towel **100** comprising the long swath of fabric **102** is merely exemplary. The handles **103** may be formed with separate pieces of fabric so that each handle **103** is secured separately to the face **101** of the drying towel **100**. Further, while stitching is shown, the handle **103** may be secured to the face **101** of the drying towel **100** via other attachment methods, e.g., fabric glue. Further note that while a plurality of handles is shown, there may be fewer or more handles **103** in other embodiments.

(14) The exemplary drying towel **100** further comprises a short rectangular swath of fabric **106** along the short edge **113** of the drying towel **100**. The short rectangular swath of fabric **106** is secured to the face **101** of drying towel at regular intervals along the short rectangular swath of fabric **106** via stitches **109**.

(15) The stitches **109** form the handle **107**. The handle **107** forms an opening **108** in which the caregiver can slip his/her hand.

(16) Note that the exemplary drying towel **100** comprising the short swath of fabric **106** is merely exemplary. The handle **107** may be formed with separate pieces of fabric so that each handle **107** is secured separately to the face **101** of the drying towel **100**. Further, while stitching is shown, the handle **103** may be secured to the face **101** of the drying towel **100** via other attachment methods, e.g., fabric glue. Further note that while a plurality of handles is shown, there may be fewer or more handles **107** in other embodiments.

(17) FIG. 2 is a top plan view of the exemplary drying towel **100** in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. The drying towel **100** comprises the long edges **110** and **111** and the short edges **112** and **113**.

(18) The handles **103** and **107** are secured to the face **101** of the drying towel **100** at or near the edges **110** and **111** and/or **112** and **113**, respectively. Securing the handles **103** and **107** at or near

the edges **110** and **111** and/or **112** and **113** allows the caregiver full use of the opposite face (not shown) of the drying towel **100** for drying a disabled person. In use, a caregiver may slip his/her hand (not shown) through the handles **103** and **107** to maintain a grasp on the drying towel **100** and to have full use of the face (not shown) of the drying towel **100** opposite the face **101** to which the handles **103** and **107** are secured.

(19) The exemplary drying towel **100** comprises the long rectangular swath of fabric **102** along the long edge **111** of the drying towel **100**. The long rectangular swath of fabric **102** is secured to the face **101** of drying towel **100** at regular intervals along the long rectangular swath of fabric **102** via stitches **105** (FIG. 1).

(20) The stitches **105** form the handle **103**. The handle **103** forms the opening **104** (FIG. 1) in which the caregiver can slip his/her hand.

(21) The exemplary drying towel **100** comprises the short rectangular swath of fabric **106** along the long edge **113** of the drying towel **100**. The short rectangular swath of fabric **106** is secured to the face **101** of drying towel **100** at regular intervals along the short rectangular swath of fabric **106** via stitches **109**.

(22) The stitches **109** form the handle **107**. The handle **107** forms the opening **108** (FIG. 1) in which the caregiver can slip his/her hand.

(23) FIG. 3 is a side view of a long side edge **110** or **111** of the drying towel **100**. The drying towel **100** comprises the swath of fabric **102** at or near the edge **110** or **111** of the drying towel **100**. The swath of fabric **102** is secured to the face **101** of the drying towel **100** via a plurality of stitches **105** at regular intervals.

(24) The stitches **105** form the handle **103**. The handle **103** forms the opening **104**. The opening **104** receives a caregiver's hand so that the caregiver can easily grasp the drying towel **100** when drying a disabled person (not shown).

(25) As noted above, the drying towel **100** comprising the long swath of fabric **106** is merely exemplary. The handle **107** may be formed with separate pieces of fabric so that each handle **107** is secured separately to the face **101** of the drying towel **100**. Further, while stitching is shown, the handle **103** may be secured to the face **101** of the drying towel **100** via other attachment methods, e.g., fabric glue. Further note that while a plurality of handles is shown, there may be fewer or more handles **107** in other embodiments.

(26) FIG. 4 is a side view of a short side edge **112** or **113** of the drying towel **100**. The drying towel **100** comprises the swath of fabric **106** at or near the edge **112** and/or **113** of the drying towel **100**. The swath of fabric **106** is secured to the face **101** of the drying towel **100** via the plurality of stitches **109** at regular intervals.

(27) The stitches **109** form the handle **107**. The handle **107** forms the opening **108**. The opening **108** receives a caregiver's hand so that the caregiver can easily grasp the drying towel **100** when drying a disabled person (not shown).

(28) As noted above, the drying towel **100** comprising the short swath of fabric **106** is merely exemplary. The handle **107** may be formed with separate pieces of fabric so that each handle **107** is secured separately to the face **101** of the drying towel **100**. Further, while stitching is shown, the handle **103** may be secured to the face **101** of the drying towel **100** via other attachment methods, e.g., fabric glue. Further note that while a plurality of handles is shown, there may be fewer or more handles **107** in other embodiments. Also note that handles **103** and **107** are shown along the long edges **110** and **111** and the short edges **112** and **113**. While handles **103** and **107** are shown along all four edges **110**, **111**, **112**, and **113**, handles **103** and **107** may be secured along only one edge, two edges, or three edges in other embodiments.

(29) FIG. 5 is a top view of another embodiment of an exemplary towel **500** in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. In such an embodiment, the towel **500** comprises handles **503** and **504** at each short end of the towel **500**. The handles **503** and **504** are secured to the face **501** of the drying towel **500** at or near the edges **505** and **506**, respectively. Securing the handles

503 and **504** at or near the edges **505** and **506** allows the caregiver full use of the opposite face (not shown) of the drying towel **500** for drying a disabled person. In use, a caregiver may slip his/her hand (not shown) through the handles **503** and **504** to maintain a grasp on the drying towel **500** and to have full use of the face (not shown) of the drying towel **500** opposite the face **501** to which the handles **503** and **504** are secured.

(30) In one embodiment, the exemplary drying towel **500** comprises rectangular swaths of fabric **502** and **507** along the edges **505** and **504**, respectively, of the drying towel **500**. The rectangular swaths of fabric **502** and **507** are secured to the face **501** of drying towel **500** at regular intervals along the short ends **508** and **509** of the face **501** via stitches **510** and **511**, respectively.

(31) The stitches **510** and **511** form the handles **503** and **504**. The handles **503** and **504** form openings like those openings **104** (FIG. 1) in which the caregiver can slip his/her hand.

(32) FIG. 6 is a top view of another embodiment of an exemplary towel **600** in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. In such an embodiment, the towel **600** comprises handles **603** and **604** at the long ends **608** and **609** of the towel **600**. The handles **603** and **604** are secured to the face **601** of the drying towel **600** at or near the edges **605** and **606**, respectively. Securing the handles **603** and **604** at or near the edges **608** and **609** allows the caregiver full use of the opposite face (not shown) of the drying towel **600** for drying a disabled person. In use, a caregiver may slip his/her hand (not shown) through the handles **603** and **604** to maintain a grasp on the drying towel **600** and to have full use of the face (not shown) of the drying towel **600** opposite the face **601** to which the handles **603** and **604** are secured.

(33) In one embodiment, the exemplary drying towel **600** comprises long rectangular swaths of fabric **602** and **607** along the long edges **605** and **606**, respectively, of the drying towel **600**. The long rectangular swaths of fabric **602** and **607** are secured to the face **601** of drying towel **600** at regular intervals along the long ends **608** and **609** of the face **601** via stitches **610** and **611**.

(34) The stitches **610** and **611** form the handles **603** and **604**. The handles **603** and **604** form openings like those openings **104** (FIG. 1) in which the caregiver can slip his/her hand.

Claims

1. A drying apparatus, comprising: a drying towel having a first face and a second face opposite the first face; and a plurality of handles positioned on each end of the first face, wherein each handle of the plurality of handles extending from and being secured to the first face of the drying towel, wherein each handle defines an opening, with the first face of the drying towel, through which a caregiver can insert a hand to grasp the drying towel, thereby allowing the second face to dry a disabled person.
 2. The drying apparatus of claim 1, wherein the plurality of handles is secured to the first face at regular intervals via stitches.
 3. The drying apparatus of claim 1, wherein each handle comprises a swath of fabric secured to the first face via stitches.
-